# Getting Ready for Jobs in AI-Everywhere Environments

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**DEDICATION**

This guide was originally designed to help the students and alumni of the Technology Innovation Management (TIM) program at Carleton University in Ottawa, Canada, and was expanded to meet the needs of a global audience.

"This guide is dedicated to all recent university graduates who are searching for jobs in the new AI-everywhere job environments, and to all those who are helping them, around the world."

Professor Tony Bailetti, PhD
February 7, 2026, at 12:40 a.m.

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**INTRODUCTION TO THIS GUIDE**

AI is changing what counts as valuable work. Many routine tasks are now easy to automate. What remains scarce are the capabilities to frame real problems worth solving, use evidence well, design opportunities, exercise judgment, make and justify decisions, and work effectively with AI.

This guide explains what is changing, what capabilities matter, what artifacts to produce to prove those capabilities, and practical steps to signal your value in job searches, CVs, and interviews.

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**BENEFITS THIS GUIDE OFFERS**

- For recent university graduates who apply the guidance: This guide will support you in securing good jobs in AI-everywhere environments.
- For employers reading this guide: This guide will help enable the talent you need to be developed for the age we have moved into. You are encouraged to support those who are working on this.

## CHARACTERISTICS OF AI-EVERYWHERE JOB ENVIRONMENTS

1. **AI is embedded in almost all work**
   AI is no longer a separate tool or specialty. It is becoming part of everyday workflows across industries and roles worldwide.
2. **Routine cognitive and operational work is automated**
   Tasks such as drafting, coding, summarizing, and basic analyzing are increasingly handled by AI.
3. **Human value shifts to higher order thinking**
   What remains valuable is the capability to frame problems, use evidence, exercise judgment, make decisions, and work effectively with AI.
4. **Jobs are defined by capabilities, not by function, title, or personal job desires**
   As AI reshapes tasks and workflows, titles and the labels you give yourself matter less than the capabilities you can apply consistently across different situations.
5. **Work is organized around problems, not departments or functions**
   Problems become the primary organizing unit for delivering work. Teams assemble to solve a problem and reconfigure as it evolves.
6. **Most jobs include human–AI collaboration**
   Good performance depends on how well you guide, evaluate, and integrate AI outputs.
7. **Evidence and accountability matter more than activity**
   When outputs are easy to generate, what matters more than being busy is making evidence-grounded decisions and delivering outcomes you can defend.
8. **Continuous learning is part of the job**
   Knowledge, tools, and jobs evolve quickly. You are expected to keep renewing and extending your capabilities on the job and throughout your career.

## CAPABILITIES THAT GIVE YOU AN ADVANTAGE IN AI-EVERYWHERE JOB MARKETS

Your advantage in the AI-everywhere job market will not come from being the fastest at using AI tools or from knowing the most about A, B, and C at any given time.

You will have a clear advantage if you can:

1. Frame real problems worth solving
2. Use evidence well
3. Design opportunities
4. Exercise judgment
5. Make and justify decisions
6. Work effectively with AI

Having these capabilities makes you easier to hire and harder to replace in AI-everywhere environments.

### 1 - Frame Real Problems Worth Solving

Clearly describe a real problem that matters:

- Identify who has the problem
- Describe what is going wrong
- Explain why it matters
- Distinguish root causes from symptoms

### 2 - Use Evidence Well

Find, evaluate, and use credible evidence to support your thinking :

- Design a search strategy for relevant sources
- Judge whether sources are credible
- Extract key findings from sources
- Synthesize evidence into insights

### 3 - Design Opportunities

Turn a problem into a promising idea for action that creates value:

- Translate a problem into a potential solution
- Describe who would benefit and how
- Articulate the value created

### 4 - Exercise Judgment

Evaluate situations and determine what matters most:

- Identify what is important versus what is secondary

- Recognize constraints and risks
- Weigh benefits against downsides
- Decide what information is sufficient to act
- Explain the reasoning behind your evaluations

**5 - Make and Justify Decisions**

Choose an option and clearly explain why it is the best choice:

- Define decision criteria
- Compare alternatives using evidence
- Identify and explain trade-offs
- Select a recommended option
- Present full decision rationale

**6 - Work Effectively with AI**

Use AI as a thinking partner, not a shortcut:

- Brainstorm to generate new idea
- Break large tasks into smaller parts
- Write clear prompts
- Evaluate AI outputs
- Refine prompts and outputs
- Document an AI-supported workflow.
- Rapid prototyping

**PORTFOLIO OF ARTIFACTS THAT RECENT UNIVERSITY GRADUATES WORLDWIDE ARE ENCOURAGED TO BUILD**

An artifact is a concrete piece of work that provides evidence that you have the capabilities to effectively work in AI-everywhere environments worldwide.

A strong portfolio showcases concrete artifacts as evidence of how you think, frame problems, use evidence, learn from outcomes, and make decisions—with AI as a partner. To produce a strong portfolio, you should build and showcase at least seven high-quality artifacts.

## STRONG VS. WEAK PORTFOLIO

### Strong portfolio

- Clear problem framing supported by evidence
- Artifacts that show reasoning, trade-offs, and decisions
- Documented use of AI to improve the quality of thinking and outcomes

### Weak portfolio signals

- Lists of courses completed
- Lists of tools used
- List of job titles you want to have (e.g., data analyst)
- Reports with no clear problem, evidence, or decision

A weak portfolio describes activity, not capability. Employers cannot see how you think, what you can do, or how you use AI to produce defensible outcomes.

## ARTIFACTS TO PRODUCE FOR YOUR PORTFOLIO

You are encouraged to build a coherent set of artifacts drawn from the list below. Not all artifacts are required for everyone; the goal is to assemble a portfolio that clearly demonstrates your capabilities.

1. Problem Brief
2. Evidence Table
3. Opportunity Brief
4. Decision Memo
5. Trade-Off Analysis Matrix
6. AI Workflow Note
7. Prompt Log
8. Market Scan / Landscape Brief
9. Concept Test Summary

**ARTIFACTS: WHAT TO PRODUCE**

Use the guidance below to understand what each artifact is for and what it must include. These descriptions are intentionally concise so you can act on them quickly.

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|---|---|
| **1 - Problem Brief (1–2 pages)**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Frame a real problem worth solving. | **Must include**<br><br>• Who has the problem<br>• What is happening<br>• Why it matters<br>• Evidence the problem exists |
| **2 - Evidence Table**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Support claims with credible evidence. | **Must include**<br><br>• Claim<br>• Source<br>• Key evidence<br>• Insight<br>• Implication<br>• Risk or limitation |
| **3 - Opportunity Brief (2–3 pages)**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Translate a problem into a viable opportunity. | **Must include**<br><br>• Target user<br>• Problem<br>• Proposed solution<br>• Value created<br>• Why now |
| **4 - Decision Memo (1–2 pages)**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Demonstrate judgment and decision-making. | **Must include**<br><br>• Options considered<br>• Evaluation criteria<br>• Comparison of options<br>• Recommendation<br>• Rationale and trade-offs |
| **5 - Trade-Off Analysis Matrix**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Compare options systematically. | **Must include**<br><br>• Options<br>• Cost<br>• Feasibility<br>• Impact<br>• Risk |

| | |
|---|---|
| **6 - AI Workflow Note**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Show productive human–AI collaboration. | **Must include**<br>• Objective<br>• Tasks<br>• Prompts used<br>• Outputs generated<br>• How outputs were evaluated and improved |
| **7 - Prompt Log**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Document iterative AI use. | **Must include**<br>• Goal<br>• Prompt<br>• Output quality<br>• What was changed and why |
| **8 - Market Scan / Landscape Brief**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Demonstrate contextual and strategic awareness. | **Must include**<br>• Key players<br>• Trends<br>• Gaps<br>• Implications |
| **9 - Concept Test Summary**<br><br>**Purpose**<br>Show learning from users or stakeholders. | **Must include**<br>• Who you spoke to<br>• What you tested<br>• What you learned<br>• How your thinking or direction changed |

## PRACTICAL TIPS FOR PORTFOLIO BUILDING

Treat your portfolio as a professional work product stored in a simple website, note-taking software, or a well-organized folder.

### 1 - Start with a Minimum Set of Artifacts (Quality matters more than quantity)

At a minimum, your portfolio should include:

- 1 Problem Brief
- 1 Evidence Table
- 1 Opportunity Brief
- 1 Decision Memo
- 1 AI Workflow Note

**2 – Position Yourself How You Want Others to See You**

To support positioning yourself, include:

- A short positioning statement that answers: *What kinds of problems am I ready to work on?*
- A clear call to action (start, middle, or end of the portfolio)
- An optional photo or short video introduction

**3 - Organize for Fast Scanning**

Assume reviewers will spend 30–90 seconds on your portfolio.

For each artifact in the portfolio, include:

- A clear title
- A short context paragraph explaining the problem, your role, and the outcome
- A clean, readable PDF

**4 - Show Thinking, Not University Coursework**

Do not upload:

- Full course reports
- Slides without context
- Tool demonstrations without decisions

Curate artifacts that show reasoning, trade-offs, and judgment.

**5 - Make AI Use Explicit**

For any artifact where AI was used:

- Explain how AI supported your thinking
- Explain what you accepted, rejected, or changed

This signals maturity, not dependence.

## PRACTICAL TIPS FOR JOB SEARCHES

### 1 - Search by capabilities, not job titles

Titles are inconsistently applied across firms. Capability signals show up in the responsibilities, deliverables, and tools listed in postings.

Do not limit yourself to titles like “Business Analyst” or “Product Manager.” Search using capability keywords and the artifacts those capabilities produce, for example:

- Customer discovery, market research, competitive analysis
- Experimentation, A/B testing, causal inference, KPI design
- Financial modeling, unit economics, pricing, forecasting
- Requirements gathering, process mapping, operational improvement
- Stakeholder management, briefing notes, decision memos, product requirements documents
- Prompt design, workflow automation, output evaluation, AI agent orchestration

Also consider adjacent titles, but treat them as noisy labels:

- Innovation Analyst, Strategy Analyst, Venture Analyst, Growth Analyst, Operations Analyst

### 2 - Examine job posting phrases

Look for phrases such as:

- “problem-solving”
- “research and analysis”
- “cross-functional”
- “ambiguity”
- “evaluate options”
- “recommendations”

These are clues that judgment and framing work are needed. Focus on these when selecting what capabilities to highlight in a cover letter or when answering interview questions.

### 3 - Apply based on capabilities, not tools

Do not self-select out of opportunities because of missing knowledge about tools.

You are already competitive if you can demonstrate:

- Problem framing
- Evidence use
- Decision-making

Knowledge, tools, and jobs change quickly. Capabilities compound. Employers hire for what you can figure out, not just what you already know.

Remember: Capabilities are more important than tools.

**4 - Customize one high-impact paragraph per application**

Stop sending the same cover letter with every application. Adapt it each time.

For each cover letter, customize a short paragraph that states:

- At least one problem you can help the organization solve
- At least one artifact you produced that proves you can solve it
- At least one outcome or insight you can transfer to their context

Focus on your capabilities and artifacts much more than your interests.
Connect evidence about the capabilities you have to outcomes that they care about.
This immediately differentiates you from most applicants.

**PRACTICAL TIPS FOR CV/RESUME BUILDING**

**1 - Use capability-oriented bullets**

Instead of:
"Used ChatGPT for research."

Write:

- Framed client problem and synthesized evidence using AI-supported research
- Designed and evaluated three opportunity options using AI-assisted analysis
- Produced decision memo recommending highest-impact option

**2 - Write Capability-Based CV Bullets**

Use this structure for writing every bullet about your work experience:
**Action + Capability + Artifact + Outcome**

- Action – Start with a specific action verb
- Capability – Name the capability you demonstrated (e.g., problem framing, evidence use, judgment)
- Artifact – Identify the artifact you produced (e.g., problem brief, evidence table, decision memo)
- Outcome – State the outcome as a concrete result or impact (not an adjective)

Avoid:

- Long list of all the tools used in that role
- Using vague outcomes (e.g., “successful,” “effective,” “valuable”)
- Listing job titles you want for yourself

Self-check before finalizing a bullet:

- Can someone tell what problem I worked on?
- Can they see what I produced?
- Can they see why it mattered?

If not, rewrite.

**3 - Include a “Selected Artifacts” section**

Example:
Selected Artifacts

- Problem Brief – Independent Retail Attribution Challenge
- Evidence Table – Digital Advertising ROI in SMEs
- Opportunity Brief – Low-Cost Attribution Dashboard
- Decision Memo – Option Comparison

This demonstrates capability, not just coursework.

**4 - Lead with what you can do, not what you used**

Do not start the document with lists of tools:
Python, ChatGPT, Tableau, Excel, etc.

If highlighting tools you have experience with, place under a small “Tools” section at the end of the CV.

**IMMEDIATE STEPS FOR RECENT UNIVERSITY GRADUATES**

**Step 1: Build one strong artifact per month**

Month 1 → Problem brief
Month 2 → Evidence table
Month 3 → Opportunity brief or decision memo

**Step 2: Continue weekly framing**

Write one new problem statement every week.

**Step 3: Keep an AI workflow log**

Document:

- Task
- Prompt
- Output
- What you changed

This becomes interview-ready evidence.

**Step 4: Apply while building**

Do not wait until everything is perfect.
Applying for jobs while building artifacts happens in parallel.

**Step 5: Seek Feedback**

Ask:
"Does this artifact demonstrate capability X?"
Refine based on what you learn.

## CONCLUSION

AI-everywhere job environments reward people who can think clearly, learn quickly, and produce defensible outcomes. Recent university graduates worldwide should build capabilities by producing artifacts. Then use those artifacts to signal your value in interviews, portfolios, and on your CV.

## CALL FOR FEEDBACK

Do you have feedback that will help make this document stronger?
Please email your contributions to Eduardo Bailetti, MEnt at:
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AI Disclaimer: ChatGPT was used as a thinking partner to produce this document.